DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 6

Marketing automation and CRM specialist

Profession 6 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A marketing automation and CRM specialist designs how leads move through the business: scoring, routing, follow-up and reporting in a CRM, with automation tools connecting them.

What professionals do every day

Defines lead stages, builds automations and CRM pipelines, sets scoring rules, connects forms and channels, and reports on pipeline and sales handoff.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Leads often go cold because no one follows up on time. Automation and a clear pipeline close the gap between marketing and sales.

- Leads lost between marketing and sales.
- Manual follow-up that is late or missed.
- Pipelines nobody can read.

Skills you need

- Pipeline stages and lead scoring.
- CRM basics (HubSpot free CRM, Zoho).
- Automation tools (n8n, Make, Zapier).
- Data quality and consent.
- Reporting.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
HubSpot CRM	CRM and marketing automation	Free CRM tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com
Zoho CRM	CRM for small teams	Free plan	Paid plans	www.zoho.com/crm/
n8n	Custom automations	Self-hosted free	Cloud plans	n8n.io
Make	Visual automations	Free tier	Paid plans	www.make.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a five-stage pipeline in a free CRM.
Intermediate	Automate a lead alert to a salesperson.
Advanced	Create a lead score with three rules.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Sales pipeline for a training firm.
- **Intermediate:** Lead routing for a property agency.
- **Advanced:** Follow-up automation for a clinic.

Client-ready portfolio project

A lead-to-sale system for a fictional education company: pipeline, scoring rules, routing, a follow-up automation and a weekly dashboard.

Worked example

Worked example. Score: +2 for a call request, +1 for an email open, +3 for a visit to the price page. A lead at 5 points goes to a salesperson within an hour.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Lead scoring and alert

Business problem: A training firm wants hot leads to reach sales quickly.

Steps

1. Define three scoring rules with points.
2. Set an alert threshold at 5 points.
3. Route the alert to the owner of the lead's region.
4. Test with three sample leads: low, threshold, high.

Expected output: The rules, the threshold and the three test results.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Three rules keep the score easy to explain. The threshold is tested with a lead exactly at the limit, which is where mistakes happen.

Common mistakes

- Scoring rules nobody can explain.
- Duplicated leads.
- Automation without consent checks.
- No handover from marketing to sales.

Freelancing opportunities

- CRM setup and automation for small firms.
- Pipeline audits.
- Briefs for 'HubSpot', 'CRM setup', 'marketing automation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- HubSpot Academy
- Zoho CRM training

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